

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Pot Holder Pattern for Beginners

A double-thickness square worked in cotton, sized and built specifically for heat safety in the kitchen.

Updated 2026 • US terms • About 8in / 20cm square



This pot holder is built as two square panels worked together, using the same flat single crochet technique as our [dishcloth pattern](#). Working two layers together from the start is what makes this piece safe for handling hot cookware, unlike a single-layer dishcloth.

Kitchen safety note: use 100% cotton yarn only and keep tension tight throughout. Never substitute acrylic or other synthetic yarn, which can melt at high heat. See the FAQ below for more detail.

MATERIALS

- 1 skein 100% cotton worsted-weight yarn (about 100–120 yards)
- 4.0mm (US size G) crochet hook — smaller than usual, for a tighter, safer fabric
- Scissors

- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.	MEANS
ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.



Assorted crochet notions and thread for finishing a pot holder

GAUGE

16 sc and 18 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 4.0mm hook and cotton yarn — noticeably tighter than our other patterns, which is intentional for heat safety.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, using the same flat single crochet technique as our [dishcloth pattern](#), worked at a tighter gauge.
- Two identical squares are made and joined together for double thickness.
- Cotton yarn is not optional here — it's the safe choice for anything near heat.

Pattern (make 2 identical squares)

FOUNDATION

Chain 33.

ROW 1

Single crochet in the 2nd chain from the hook, and in each chain across. Turn.
(32 sts)

ROWS 2–32

Chain 1 (does not count as a stitch), single crochet in each stitch across. Turn.
(32 sts each row)

Repeat until the square measures about 8in / 20cm, roughly 32 rows for this gauge. Fasten off, leaving a long tail on the second square only.

JOINING

Hold both squares together with wrong sides facing in. Using the tail left on the second square, single crochet around all four sides through both layers at once, working 3 sc in each corner to keep it flat.

HANGING LOOP

At one corner, before fastening off, chain 8 and slip stitch back into the same corner to form a hanging loop.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

Is crochet safe to use as a pot holder?

Yes, when worked at a tight gauge in 100% cotton yarn and doubled for thickness. Loose stitches or synthetic yarn are not recommended, since synthetic fibres can melt at high temperatures.

Why should pot holders be worked double thickness?

A single layer of crochet fabric doesn't provide enough insulation to safely handle a hot pot or pan; working two layers together, or folding and joining two pieces, creates a barrier thick enough to protect hands.

What yarn is safest for crochet pot holders?

100% cotton worsted-weight yarn is the standard choice, since it doesn't melt like acrylic and holds up well to repeated washing.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.